ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** a source of future income	Rain meant a good harvest and money.
2	**(a)** the helper is accused of cheating	Irony of situation.
3	**(c)** Despite the hail, Lencho kept his faith.	'Despite' is followed directly by a noun.
4	**(d)** completeness of the destruction	Even flowers were gone.
5	**(a)** faithful and naive	He trusts God absolutely and men not at all.
6	**(b)** adverb	It modifies 'sat'.
7	**(a)** his faith was in God above all	Faith was his first refuge.
8	**(c)** ingratitude	He blames helpers.
9	**(c)** the top	Crest = the highest point.
10	**(c)** He is simple and sincerely trusting	Honest innocence.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	To show how much Lencho had to lose (1) and to create contrast with the hail disaster later (1).	1+1
12	He and his friends had limited means (1) and could not match the full amount in a short time (1).	1+1
13	The man who gave help is blamed (1) while Lencho remains sure he is right (1).	1+1
14	He realised the letter was written with deep faith (1) and saw that it deserved help, not mockery (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The ripe field and flowers show promise (1). Lencho compares raindrops to coins (1). This makes the hail more shocking (1).	1+1+1
16	The corn was the main source of food (1). They have no crop to sell or eat (1). That is why Lencho asks for money to sow again (1).	1+1+1
17	The postmaster said that he would reply to that letter (1). 'shall' becomes 'would' and 'this' becomes 'that' (1). Own correct example (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He trusts God completely (1) yet suspects the humans who helped him (1). He fails to see that God's help came through those same people (1).	1+1+1
18	Lencho's hope is tied to money like coins (1). He asks for a hundred pesos (1). Its shortage turns his gratitude into anger (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Lencho believed that the money had been taken by the clerks (1). The clerks are the doers (1). In passive the object is made the subject (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hardworking: tends his field (1). Faithful: writes to God (1). Naive: expects to be answered directly (1). Ungrateful: calls helpers crooks (1). Conclusion: sympathetic but flawed (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Beginning: he welcomes rain (1). Hail changes him to sorrow (1). He does not blame nature or God (1). He puts blame on men at the end (1). So nature teaches resilience (1).	2+2+1
20	Initial amusement turns to sympathy (1). Willingness to help from his salary (1). Initiative: rallies friends (1). Clever device of signing as God (1). Humility: accepts blame (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline and byline (1). Lead paragraph with who, what, when (1). Details of hail and loss (1). Postmaster's action (1). Quote and conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.
- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.
- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.
- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.
- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.
- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** People can show kindness even to strangers	He helped a stranger.
2	**(d)** good-natured	Amiable = pleasant.
3	**(a)** understood the depth of Lencho's faith	The sentiment moved him.
4	**(b)** He decided to write to God for help	Hope lived through the letter.
5	**(b)** sadness and loss	A gloomy mood.
6	**(c)** He was ready to use part of his salary	Personal sacrifice.
7	**(c)** an unexpected disaster	Nature's cruelty.
8	**(b)** simile	'Like' signals a simile.
9	**(d)** To keep Lencho's belief intact	A harmless untruth for a good cause.
10	**(b)** Money was collected by the postmaster.	Past simple passive: was + V3.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He had full faith in an answer (1) so he expected it as natural (1).	1+1
12	It stands for sudden disaster (1) and the farmer's helplessness before nature (1).	1+1
13	He is simple and sincere (1) and believes God can be reached by post (1).	1+1
14	He found it less than a hundred pesos (1) and concluded that it was kept back by the clerks (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He saw faith as precious (1). He used his own money to protect it (1). Kindness can protect another's belief (1).	1+1+1
16	The story begins from the letter (1). The postmaster's reaction depends on it (1). The ending also comes from a letter (1).	1+1+1
17	Correct sentence for each word, 1 mark each (3).	1+1+1
	OR: Lencho feels sorrow, but keeps hope (1). The postmaster first laughs, then feels sympathy (1). Both show a change of heart that reveals character (1).	1+1+1
18	He is cheerful and friendly (1). He gives money without gain (1). He accepts blame silently (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Hail looks like frozen coins or salt (1). The image of white salt on the field is striking (1). It makes the loss visual (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Lencho's faith gave courage (1). He assumed God sends cash through post (1). When less arrives, he blames men (1). Better understanding would make him grateful (1). Conclusion: faith needs wisdom (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Lencho is innocent (1). Postmaster knows the world (1). Experience protects innocence (1). Innocence cannot see experience's kindness (1). Therefore the clash produces irony (1).	2+2+1
20	Postmaster's willingness to help (1). Cost to himself (1). Staff and friends share (1). Kindness without need of thanks (1). Contrast with Lencho's response (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting and topic (1). Postmaster as example (1). Reasons why we help (1). Lessons for our lives (1). Closing appeal (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lencho *asked for 100 pesos and the postmaster sent 100*; the postmaster could collect only about 70 pesos, which is why Lencho later complains.
- Saying Lencho lost faith in God; his faith in God stays unshaken. He doubts only the **post-office employees**, calling them a 'bunch of crooks'.

- Mixing up the weather images: the raindrops were like *new coins* (a simile), and the hail did more damage than a plague of locusts; do not call both 'hail like coins'.
- Ignoring the **irony** in the ending: the man who trusts God completely is the one who suspects honest people; the postmaster's kindness is exactly what Lencho fails to see.
- Writing that the postmaster ignored the letter; he first laughed, then was moved, and wrote a reply signed **'God'** to keep Lencho's faith alive.
- Spelling slips: *Lencho, postmaster, hailstorm, plague of locusts*; and using 'who' for things (the letter *which*, not who).

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **A Letter to God (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** The letter drives the whole plot	Everything centres on the letter.
2	**(d)** God could not make a mistake	Faith made him sure.
3	**(c)** had read	Past perfect for the earlier action.
4	**(a)** kindness unrecognised	Help unappreciated.
5	**(c)** suspicion of people	He blamed the clerks.
6	**(a)** subordinate clause	'Because' begins a dependent clause.
7	**(a)** He stopped believing in God after the hail	His faith remained.
8	**(a)** does not know who helped him	He still believes God sent the money.
9	**(b)** Lencho, a poor farmer, wrote to God.	Appositive is set off by commas.
10	**(b)** were	Plural subject, past tense.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	His faith in God never wavered (1) but his trust in humans was weak (1).	1+1
12	He respected the strength of Lencho's belief (1) and chose to help rather than expose the letter as foolish (1).	1+1
13	He still addresses God (1) and asks Him to send the balance without using the post (1).	1+1
14	Weather controls the farmer's life (1) and sets up the later crisis (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He expected an answer (1). His faith was absolute (1). He did not see how strange his request was (1).	1+1+1
16	The first letter was hopeful (1). The second is complaining (1). The change adds irony and humour (1).	1+1+1
17	He sees God as all-knowing (1). He is a simple man with deep belief (1). It reveals his character (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It was meant to protect belief (1). He gained nothing personally (1). The intention was good even if the method was not literal (1).	1+1+1
18	The postmaster keeps the secret (1). That keeps the irony intact (1). It lets the reader judge (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Faith in God vs distrust in men (1). Hope vs disaster (1). Laughter vs sympathy (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Format with address and date (1). Describes the strange letter (1). Explains his feelings (1). Mentions the money gathered (1). Closes with a hope that Lencho's faith survives (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Reply arrives, money counted (1). Amount is less (1). He writes another letter (1). He insults the clerks (1). Reveals ungratefulness and constant faith (1).	2+2+1
20	Letter addressed to God is comic (1). Postmaster laughing is humorous (1). Ending is ironic (1). Irony helps present a gentle moral (1). Tone remains sympathetic (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Correct format (1). Lencho complains (1). Postmaster answers politely (1). Truth partly revealed (1). Lencho's reaction (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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